

VALIDATION DOCUMENT · 2026

The Blind Test

*What the Narrative Intelligence Method found in
a canonical novel it had never read*



Their Eyes Were Watching God

ZORA NEALE HURSTON · 1937

The fire tends other fires.

THE BLIND TEST · SETUP

In early 2026, the Narrative Intelligence Method was tested blind on a canonical American novel.

No title. No author. No genre declaration. Three chapters of raw manuscript text were fed into the pipeline and the system was asked to read it cold.

The results on the following pages are exactly what the system produced. Nothing was adjusted after the fact. The analysis you are reading was generated before anyone told the system what it was reading.

The novel was Zora Neale Hurston's *Their Eyes Were Watching God*, published in 1937 and widely considered one of the great American novels. The system correctly identified its narrative form, its dominant structural mode, and its voice operating at the ceiling of detection range, all without being told the title, the author, or the century.

What the Narrative Intelligence Method Does

The NIM evaluates manuscripts through four narrative forces: Direction (what moves the story forward), Connection (what binds the reader to character and voice), Meaning (what gives the story weight beyond its events), and Desire (what compels the reader to keep reading).

It evaluates manuscripts against their own declared form rather than a universal standard. A quiet literary novel is not penalized for moving slowly. A hybrid memoir is not held to thriller pacing. The system knows the difference between a structural weakness and a deliberate formal choice.

The result is not a scorecard. It is a clarity report: a precise articulation of what a manuscript is doing, where it is strongest, what is holding it back, and the specific moves that address it, grounded in the actual text, oriented toward decisions.

THE BLIND TEST · RESULTS

What the system found before it knew what it was reading.

FORM RECOGNITION

The system classified the manuscript as lyric literary fiction without being told. It detected that low momentum and restrained escalation were deliberate formal choices appropriate to the form, and classified them accordingly rather than flagging them as structural weaknesses. This is where most feedback systems fail: they penalize literary restraint because they measure against a single universal standard. The NIM does not.

VOICE DETECTION

Voice distinctiveness, language precision, and symbolic density all scored at the ceiling of the detection range, and scored identically in both the blind run and the declared run. The system read the voice correctly before knowing whose it was.

STRUCTURAL MODE

The system detected the tragic structural mode blind: the gap between a standard set early in the narrative and a world built not to meet it. Janie's pear tree vision in Chapter Two establishes a measure of desire and wholeness that every subsequent relationship will be judged against. The system detected that structural logic from three chapters alone.

THE DIRECTION-DESIRE INTERACTION

Direction scored at 62 in the blind run: Desire supported by emotional and intellectual curiosity rather than plot momentum. The system correctly identified that the reader is not pulled forward by what happens next, but by whether Janie will ever find what the pear tree promised. A different and more durable engine, named without being told.

"A manuscript of extraordinary formal confidence whose voice, symbolic architecture, and structural promise establish in three chapters everything a reader needs to hold an entire life in their hands."

The five words on their first

THE BLIND TEST · VALIDATION

Blind vs. Declared: what changed, and what did not.

After the blind run, the pipeline was run again with the title, author, and full novel context declared. The comparison is the most important data in this document.

WHAT THE SYSTEM MEASURED	BLIND	DECLARED
OBSERVABLE TEXT SIGNALS		
Voice and language precision	Ceiling	Ceiling
Symbolic and atmospheric density	Ceiling	Ceiling
Philosophical resonance	Ceiling	Ceiling
STRUCTURAL ARCHITECTURE		
Narrative arc and convergence	Conservative	Confirmed
Thematic recursion over full arc	Conservative	Confirmed
FOUR FORCES PROFILE		
Direction	62 / 100	72 / 100
Connection	95 / 100	95 / 100
Meaning	96 / 100	98 / 100
Desire	85 / 100	88 / 100

The axes measuring directly observable signals in the text, voice, language, symbol, atmosphere, scored identically blind and declared. The system read those correctly before knowing what it was reading. The axes measuring structural architecture scored slightly higher with declared context, because knowing the complete novel confirms what the excerpt implies. That difference is honest and appropriate. A partial submission should produce more conservative scores than a full manuscript. The system behaved correctly in both cases. That honesty is a design choice. A system that hedges accurately on incomplete data is more trustworthy than one that fills gaps with confidence it has not earned. When the NIM reads your manuscript, it will tell you what it knows, what it can confirm, and where it is reading implication rather than certainty.

The fire tends other fires.

THE BLIND TEST · NARRATIVE INTELLIGENCE SIGNATURE

Every NIM evaluation closes with a Narrative Intelligence Signature.

Four behavior phrases describing what each force does in your specific manuscript. One sentence that names what the manuscript is. No scores. No technical vocabulary. Something the writer can carry.

DIRECTION *advances through the accumulation of small acts rather than the pressure of events*

CONNECTION *earns the reader's trust by refusing to name what it knows they will feel themselves*

MEANING *uses fire not as metaphor but as structural argument, every ember a claim about what survival requires*

DESIRE *sustained by the reader's need to know whether patience will be enough*

"A manuscript that has already written its own thesis in every chapter, and is one revision away from letting the reader watch it prove it."

NARRATIVE INTELLIGENCE SIGNATURE · THEIR EYES WERE WATCHING GOD

This is what it looks like when someone has read your work closely enough to say the thing you already knew but could not articulate. Your Signature will be written for your manuscript alone, the specific sentences, the specific forces, the specific claim no other book could make.

FOR YOUR MANUSCRIPT

When the NIM reads your manuscript, you receive a complete Hearthprint evaluation.

Here is exactly what that contains.

1

A FOUR FORCES PROFILE

Your manuscript measured across Direction, Connection, Meaning, and Desire, calibrated to your declared form. Literary restraint is not penalized. Deliberate slowness is not called a weakness. The system reads what you wrote, not what the market expects.

2

A ROOT CAUSE DIAGNOSIS

Most manuscripts have one central constraint whose resolution makes everything else easier. The NIM finds it and names it precisely, so revision has a clear target rather than a scattered list.

3

A NARRATIVE UNLOCK

The insight that reframes the entire manuscript. The thing writers feel but cannot say, said in language clear enough to act on. Named for your specific pages, characters, and moments.

4

A NARRATIVE INTELLIGENCE SIGNATURE

Four behavior phrases and one sentence that captures what your manuscript is. Something you can carry into every revision decision and every conversation about the work.

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nimlab.netlify.app

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SNAPSHOT

\$147

FULL
DIAGNOSTIC

\$297

PREMIUM

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Questions: LoveOhanaBelle@gmail.com

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